A-A-39A
April 5, 1984
SUPERSEDING
A-A-39
February 23, 1982

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

DETERGENT, GENERAL PURPOSE

(HARD SURFACE CLEANER; LIQUID; CONCENTRATED)

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this commercial item description in preference to Federal specification P-D-223.

Salient characteristics.

The product shall be a stable, homogeneous, liquid, heavy-duty cleaner suitable for removing heavy soils from walls, floors and other washable surfaces. The product shall be suitable for manual cleaning and for use in automatic scrubbing machines. There shall be no sediment or foreign material in the containers of the product.

Deleterious effect on flooring. The specified dilution of the product shall have no deleterious action on asphalt, vinyl or vinyl-asbestos flooring when tested as specified in ASTM D 3399, section 9.

Toxicity. The product shall be non-toxic and non-hazardous for use in enclosed spaces.

Excluded materials. The product shall not contain organic solvents or free alkali.

pH. The pH of the undiluted product shall be not greater than 10.0 when tested as specified in ASTM D 1172.

Cleaning efficiency. Prepare synthetic hard water which contains 0.132 g calcium chloride dihydrate and 0.1475 g magnesium sulfate septahydrate per liter of solution at 25 degrees C. Using the synthetic hard water for dilution, prepare the dilution of the product specified on the product label for general purpose cleaning, and a 1:64 dilution of "Clean Quick" (Proctor and Gamble Distributing Company, Cincinnati, OH 45201). Determine the cleaning efficiency of these two dilutions by the cleaning efficiency test method in Federal Specification P-D-1747. The dilution of the product shall have a cleaning efficiency not less than that of the dilution of "Clean Quick".

Wax removal. Using the synthetic hard water specified above, prepare the dilution of the product specified on the product label for wax removal, and a 1:32 dilution of "Clean Quick". When tested as specified in ASTM D 1792 - Long Term Removability Properties of Emulsion Floor Waxes, the dilution of the product shall remove two coats of water emulsion floor wax in the same number or fewer strokes than the dilution of "Clean Quick".

The product shall be labeled in conformance with the Federal Hazardous Substances Act Regulations (Code of Federal Regulations, Title 16, Part 1500.)

The product label shall contain directions for dilution and use as a general purpose cleaner and a wax remover.

The issues of the referenced test methods in effect on the date of the solicitation shall be used to determine compliance with stated requirements.

Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling and marking. The preservation, packaging, packing, labeling and marking shall be as specified in the contract or order.

Notes:

ASTM Standards are available from the American Society for Testing and Material, 1916 Race Street, Philadelphia, PA 19103.

Users of this commercial item description shall state in the contract, the size containers of general purpose detergent required.

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Bid evaluation. Bids shall be evaluated on the basis of price per gallon of use-dilution solution. This is calculated as follows:

$$\text{Price per gallon of use-dilution solution} = \frac{A \times B}{C}$$

Where: A = bid price per container of general purpose detergent;
B = number of ounces of general purpose detergent needed to make one gallon of use-dilution solution for general purpose cleaning as stated on the product label. This dilution must be the same one used in the "Cleaning efficiency" performance test above; and
C = the number of ounces of general purpose detergent per container.

Bidders shall state in their bids the price per container of the general purpose detergent, the number of ounces of general purpose detergent needed to make one gallon of use-dilution solution for general purpose cleaning (by hand, not by automatic scrubbing machine) as stated on the label, and the price per gallon of use-dilution solution as calculated above.

PREPARING ACTIVITY:

GSA - FSS

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